BUILDYYC

Workshop 3

GO-TO-MARKET

MATT HAYLES

GTM Advisor & Startup Founder @ Stealth

Matt Hayles builds go-to-market engines for startups and scale-ups, from first customers to $10M ARR. Most recently VP Revenue at urllo, a bootstrapped Calgary SaaS company, he led its upmarket repositioning and ran marketing, sales and customer success to cross $2M ARR and double customer lifetime value.



BUILDYYC 2026 · WORKSHOP #3

Your demo is the starting line.

How to build a business that survives and thrives beyond Saturday.

Matt Hayles · GTM advisor & startup founder (stealth)

WHERE I'M COMING FROM

In 2010, my cousin Gabe and I built restaurant shift scheduling software at a Toronto hackathon.

Schedify didn't go anywhere.



Me and Gabe at summer camp

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

15+ years taking products to market

2
profitable businesses

1
total failure

1
exit

Now
building in stealth

COMPANIES AND CLIENTS I'VE WORKED WITH

urllo	Virtual Gurus	Edelman	BlackBerry
Intuit	Aurora Cannabis	Starbucks	KPMG

Tonight I'm redoing the Schedify business plan and go to market work with 15 years of experience.

THE BOTTOM LINE

Building has never been easier.

Winning has never been harder.

Every team in this room will have a working demo. So the demo won’t set you apart.

TONIGHT

Plan to win

01

Business model

How it makes money, who pays, and whether the numbers work

02

Go-to-market

How you reach your ICP and win the first 100 customers

03

Roadmap

Next 30 days, 90 days, 6–12 months, and a clear ask

04

Wrap up

Final thoughts and next steps

PART 01 · PITCH SLIDE 8

Is there a business here?

Who buys it, what they get, how you make money.

01 · Business model

02 · Go-to-market

03 · Roadmap

04 · Wrap up

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · INTRODUCING THE CANVAS

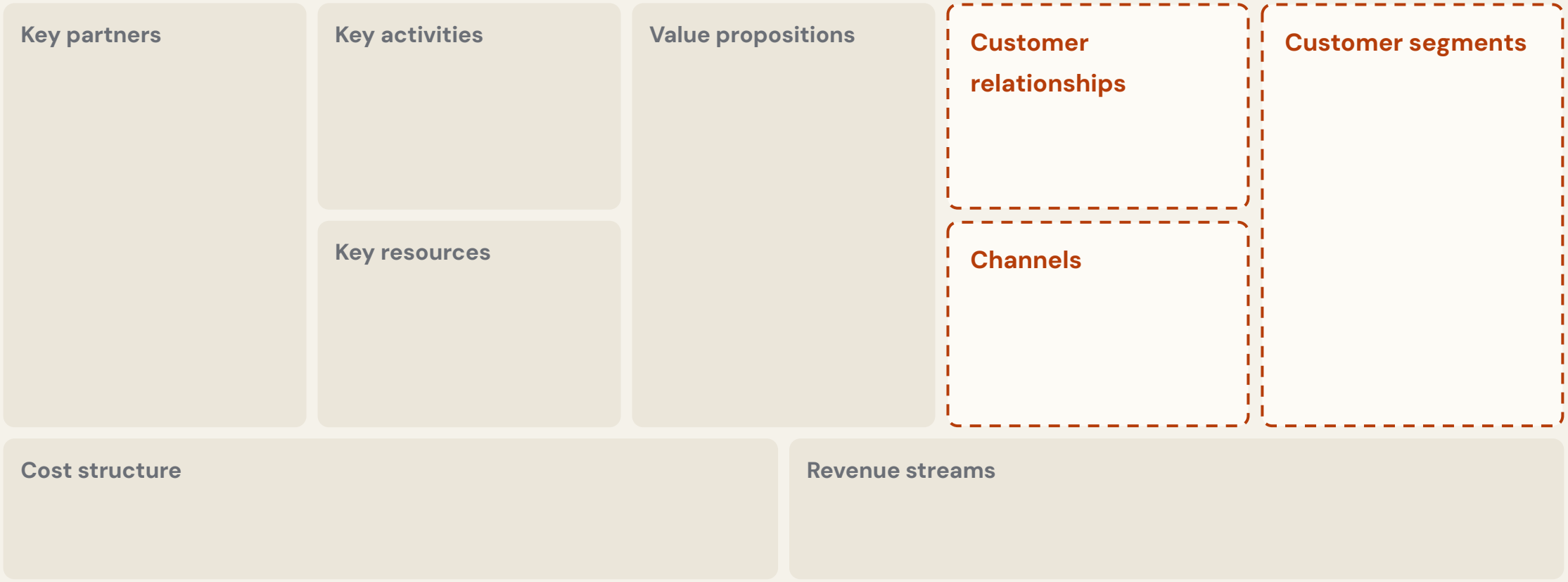
Your whole business on one page

Key partners	Key activities	Value propositions	Customer relationships	Customer segments
	Key resources		Channels	

Cost structure	Revenue streams

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Start with the three customer boxes



Business Model Canvas by Strategyzer AG (strategyzer.com), CC BY-SA 3.0.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · CUSTOMERS

Your TAM is a count of your buyers multiplied by your price. Don’t quote a report.

TOP-DOWN:
JUDGES TUNE OUT

“Restaurant tech is a multi-billion-dollar market, and we only need 1% of it.”

BOTTOM-UP: JUDGES LEAN IN

TAM	~$530M	~1.1M restaurants in Canada and the US × $480 a year
SAM	~$48M	~100,000 restaurants in Canada × $480 a year
SOM	~$1M	2,000 independent cafés won in 3 years × $480

Show your math, not just a big number. Then show it scales: every shift-based business.

Sources: IBISWorld 2025 (Canada); National Restaurant Association (US, ~1M locations). Price and SOM are illustrative.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · CUSTOMERS

Speedrun your Problem & ICP thesis

Try it: “My first customer is ___ who is trying to ___. Today they ___, and that’s not working because ___.”

THREE FAST INPUTS

AI tools
Map who feels it most, what they try today, where they gather

Desk research
Competitor reviews, Reddit and forums, job posts: their words, not yours

Founder instinct
What you’ve lived, seen or been told. Write it down as a guess

TO ANSWER THE CANVAS QUESTIONS

Customer segments
Who loses the most time, money or sleep over this? Behaviour, not demographics

Channels
Where do they already search, gather and buy?

Customer relationships
How will you win them, and what keeps them?

STRAWMAN It’s a thesis, not the truth. Write it down, then test it in the next 30 days to collect real evidence for/against.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · CUSTOMERS

Fill in boxes from Problem & ICP work

Key partners

Key activities

Key resources

Value propositions

Customer relationships

- **Get:** self-serve, plus a 15-min setup call (if needed)
- **Keep:** their whole staff uses it
- **Grow:** staff who leave bring it to their next café

Channels

2010: website

Now:

- **Walk-ins**
- **Industry orgs**
- **Trade shows**
- **Online forums**

Customer segments

2010: Restaurants

Now:

- **Indie café owners who own scheduling.**
- *Pain is last minute cancellations and swaps.*
- SOM: ~$1M a year (2,000 Canadian cafés in 3 years)

Cost structure

Revenue streams

Business Model Canvas by Strategyzer AG (strategyzer.com), CC BY-SA 3.0.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · NEXT THREE BOXES

Now these three parts

Key partners

Key activities

Key resources

Value propositions

Next

Customer relationships

- **Get:** self-serve, plus a 15-min setup call (if needed)
- **Keep:** their whole staff uses it
- **Grow:** staff who leave bring it to their next café

Channels

2010: website

Now:

- **Walk-ins**
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Cost structure

Next

Revenue streams

Next

Business Model Canvas by Strategyzer AG (strategyzer.com), CC BY-SA 3.0.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · COMPETITION

Who else solves this today?

Judges want an honest list of alternatives. If you say “no competitors,” they stop trusting the rest.

Direct
Another product built for the same job

Indirect
The workaround: a spreadsheet, a group text

Do nothing
They live with the pain. It counts.

Restaurant app	Us	Enterprise software	Group text	Do nothing
Set up in 10 minutes	✓	✗	✓	✓
Priced for one café	✓	✗	✓	✓
Shifts covered without the owner	✓	✓	✗	✗

HACK Read your competitors’ 1- to 3-star reviews on G2, Capterra, app stores and Reddit. Their customers’ complaints are your advantages.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Why can’t the incumbent just copy you?

Your best moat isn’t your code. It’s something in their business model that stops them from imitating.

ENTERPRISE SOFTWARE

- Sells big contracts to big chains
- Months-long implementations
- A sales team that can’t afford a 12-person café

RESTAURANT APP

- Set up in 10 minutes, no salesperson
- Priced for one location
- Profitable at $40 a month

BIG-BANK WEALTH FIRMS

- About half their revenue comes from advisor fees
- An online-only fund would undercut their own advisors

LAKEHOUSE

- Online-only and self-serve, no advisor
- Low fees by design

THE TEST What would they have to give up to copy you? If the answer is “nothing,” keep looking.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · DIFFERENTIATION

Pick how you'll win

The one thing that makes you the obvious choice for your ICP. It only counts if your ICP cares about it. Incomplete sample.

Choose one or two.

Asymmetric pricing Charge in a way they can't copy: per location, not per seat	**Priced less** Same job for a fraction of the price (if your costs are lower too)	**Better service** A real person answers in minutes. Big companies can't do that at scale	**Entirely online** No salesperson, no demo call. Sign up and go
Faster to value Working in 10 minutes, not after a 3-month rollout	**Built for a niche** Made for one kind of customer, so it fits better than a general tool	**Simpler** Does less, on purpose. Nothing to train anyone on	**Distribution you own** A community, audience or partner the others can't reach

For our restaurant app: entirely online, priced per café, and working in 10 minutes.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · VALUE PROPOSITION

A benefit is just a solution to a problem

Take a problem your ICP told you about in discovery. Flip it into what they get.

	PROBLEM HEARD IN DISCOVERY		THE BENEFIT
Schedify	*"I spend Sunday night texting staff to cover next week's shifts."*	→	**Get your Sunday nights back. Shifts get covered without you.**
urllo	*"Every redirect change is a dev ticket and a two-week wait."*	→	**Marketing ships redirect changes in minutes, no developer needed.**
Lakehouse	*"The bank wants a 1% fee and a big minimum to set up a Donor Advised Fund (DAF)."*	→	**Start your family's giving fund in minutes, for a fraction of the fees.**

TIP A feature is not a benefit. "One-tap shift swaps" is a feature. "Your Sunday nights back" is a benefit.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · VALUE PROPOSITION

Audience + benefit + differentiator = your value prop

A value proposition is the change in your customer's life, not your feature list. In one sentence.

FILL IN THE BLANKS

For (ICP), (product) is a (category) that (key benefit). Unlike (alternative), it (differentiator).

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · VALUE PROPOSITION

Three example value props, filled in

SCHEDIFY

2010 us: "A cloud-based, real-time workforce scheduling solution for the hospitality industry."

"For independent café owners, Schedify is a scheduling app that gives you your Sunday nights back. Unlike the group text, shifts get covered without you: staff swap themselves and you just tap approve."

urllo

"For marketing teams at growing companies, urllo is a redirect management platform that lets you ship redirect changes in minutes. Unlike filing a dev ticket and waiting two weeks, no developer is needed."

LAKEHOUSE

"For HNW families who want to maximize their charitable impact, Lakehouse is a family giving fund you can start in minutes. Unlike bank-managed DAFs and foundations, there's no big minimum, and you keep more for charity at a fraction of the fees."

Write yours tonight. Then read it to someone outside your team.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · VALUE PROPOSITION

Three iterations for your value prop

THE EXERCISE	SCHEDIFY	urllo	LAKEHOUSE
The 10-year-old one-liner Your title slide: "We help ___ do ___ so they can ___." A 10-year-old should get it.	"We help café owners find someone to cover a shift so they can stop texting staff at midnight."	"We help marketers change redirects themselves so they can stop waiting on developers."	"We help families save money for charity so they can give more away."
The moonshot exercise Name the big change you enable in society or business if you win.	"No independent restaurant ever opens short-staffed."	"No visitor ever hits a broken link."	"Enable HNW families to donate $1B to charity in the next 20 years."
The challenger exercise Lead with the enemy you replace: "We replace X with Y."	"We replace frantic Sunday night texts with one tap."	"We replace the dev ticket with a self-serve redirect dashboard."	"We replace the big-bank wealth advisor with a low-fee, self-serve giving fund."

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · REVENUE MODEL

Choose how you charge

Think beyond three plans and a monthly/annual toggle.

CORE WAYS TO CHARGE

Flat or tiered plans
Good / better / best, monthly or annual

Per seat
Each user pays. Grows with headcount.

Value metric
Per location, contact, project, etc.

Usage-based
Pay for what you use: messages, API calls, storage

Transaction fee
A cut of each payment or booking

Setup and services
One-time onboarding, implementation, training, but doesn't count as ARR/MRR

PET PEEVE

Seat-based pricing punishes customers for adding users. But users create the usage that delivers value and keeps them paying. Sometimes it's the right answer, but usually it's wrong.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · PRICING

Price on one thing your customer values

Pick one thing they care about. **Simple pricing is kind**: they know exactly what they're paying for, so there's less friction and it's easier to say yes.

URLLO

From 5 pricing metrics to 1

One value metric, priced asymmetrically. The next quarter:

RESTAURANT APP, NOW

Per location, not per employee

$40 per location, per month. Per-employee pricing punishes restaurants for hiring; per-location grows when they grow.

HACK It's best to charge for a metric that grows when they grow. **People can pay more when they have more.**

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · RETENTION DRIVERS

SaaS gets paid for value, month after month

OLD SOFTWARE: SELL THE BOX

One big licence up front. Paid back right away. The vendor wins at the sale. The buyer takes on implementation risk.

SAAS: EARN THE RENEWAL

Small payments over time. You win only if they stay. They stay only if you deliver value every day, week, month, etc.

WHY WILL THEY KEEP PAYING? NAME WHAT MAKES LEAVING PAINFUL.

Habit

They use it every week, as part of how the job gets done

Their data lives in it

History, settings and records they'd have to rebuild

Their people are on it

Switching means moving a whole team, not one login

For our restaurant app: once 15 servers swap shifts in the app every week, the owner can't go back to the group text.

Payback: perpetual licences recoup in 60–90 days; subscriptions take 15–30 months on average (Bessemer Venture Partners); target is 9-12 months.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · UNIT ECONOMICS

Can you acquire customers profitably?

CAC

What it costs to win one customer

~$200

4 hours of founder walk-ins at $50/hour

GROSS MARGIN

What's left of each dollar after hosting and support

~85%

Typical for SaaS; texting costs extra

LTV

What one customer is worth over their lifetime

~$800

$40 × 85% margin × ~24 months

4 : 1 LTV to CAC. The rule of thumb is **3 : 1 or better**. Below that, you lose money growing.

All figures illustrative. 3 : 1 benchmark via Bessemer Venture Partners. On your slide, write "we assume."

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · KEY ASSUMPTIONS

What has to be true for you to win?

Your model rests on 2 or 3 bets. Name them, and say how you'll test each.

We assume…	How we'll test it (next 30 days)
Owners will pay $40 a month to stop texting staff	Ask 20 owners for a paid pilot
Staff will install an app to swap shifts	Track installs in the first 5 cafés
One walk-in plus a 2-week trial wins a café	Count walk-ins per paying café

Estimates are fine. Guesses labelled as facts are not.

01 · BUSINESS MODEL · RECAP

Filling in another three boxes...

Key partners

Key activities

Key resources

Value propositions

Get your Sunday nights back. Shifts get covered without you: staff swap, you tap approve.

Customer relationships

- **Get:** self-serve, plus a 15-min setup call (if needed)
- **Keep:** their whole staff uses it
- **Grow:** staff who leave bring it to their next café

Channels

2010: website

Now:

- **Walk-ins**
- **Industry orgs**
- **Trade shows**
- **Online forums**

Customer segments

2010: Restaurants

Now:

- **Indie café owners who own scheduling.**
- *Pain is last minute cancellations and swaps.*
- SOM: ~$1M a year (2,000 Canadian cafés in 3 years)

Cost structure

CAC ~$200 a café (founder walk-ins) · hosting and SMS ~15% of revenue

Revenue streams

$40 per location, per month · 14-day free trial

Business Model Canvas by Strategyzer AG (strategyzer.com), CC BY-SA 3.0.

HALFTIME

That’s the business.
Now take it to market.

How will you reach and win your first 100 customers?

✓ 01 · Business model

02 · Go-to-market

03 · Roadmap

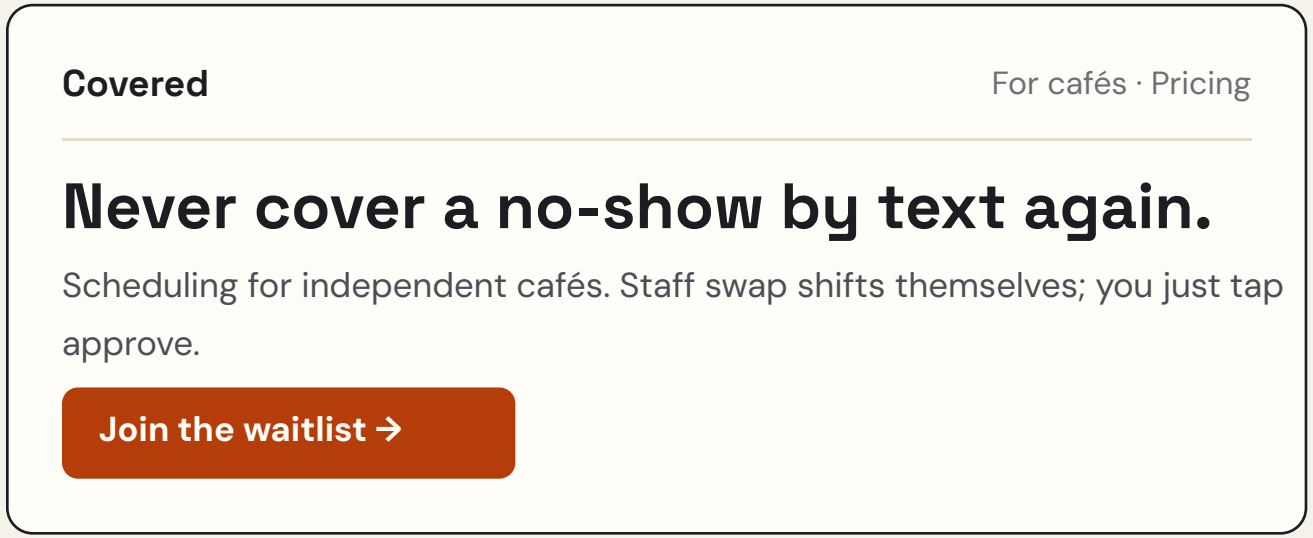
04 · Wrap up

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

MVPre: write the landing page first

Ideas are fuzzy in your head. Writing forces clarity.

- Headline: your value prop
- Subhead: who it's for and what it does
- Three benefits, not features
- How it works
- One call to action



TIP **The best CTAs give them something.** A free assessment, an ROI or cost calculator, a benchmark report, a template.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

Your price decides your go-to-market

Winning a customer costs money. It has to cost a lot less than they'll pay you.



$10s a month

Self-serve

Customers find you, try it and buy without talking to anyone

$100s a month

Inside sales

Demos over Zoom, a few calls, a decision in weeks

$10,000s a year

Enterprise sales

Pilots, procurement, many decision-makers, months

TIP **You can't send a salesperson to sell a $10 app.** And you can't sell a $100K contract with a sign-up button.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

Your model determines your channels

Model	How customers find you
Consumer app (B2C)	Friends, social (paid and organic), app stores, influencers/PR
B2B self-serve	Search & AI discovery, paid acquisition, templates
B2B sales-led	Outreach, referrals, events
Marketplace	One side pulls in the other
Partner-led	Bundled by someone who already has your customers

HACK **Make your product your marketing.** If using it puts it in front of someone new, like a Calendly link or a Dropbox share, every customer becomes a channel. That's **product-led growth**, and it works in any model.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

One idea, three businesses

Same founders. Same insight. Completely different go-to-market.

Self-serve app

$40 / month per café

SELF-SERVE

14-day free trial. Staff who move cafés bring it to their next one.

Restaurant-group software

$1,500 / month per group

SALES-LED

Call ops managers at groups with 10+ locations. Pilot in two of them.

Shift-fill marketplace

$15 per filled shift

MARKETPLACE

Recruit cooks and servers first, by hand. Then sell restaurants “fill any shift in an hour.”

In 2010, we never asked which one we were building. Dumb Matt was dumb.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

Where to start, and what to avoid

Model	First channel to try	The classic trap
Consumer app (B2C)	One community where they already hang out	Paying for ads before anyone sticks around
B2B self-serve	Content on the exact problem	“Build it and they will come”
B2B sales-led	Direct outreach to 50 named accounts	Hiring sales before the founder can close
Marketplace	Recruit the hard side first, by hand	Launching both sides at once to an empty room
Partner-led	Co-build one integration or reseller	Partners won’t sell you until you’re proven

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

First 10 → First 100 → Scale

Start with a beachhead: a market small enough that the people in it talk to each other.

FIRST 10 — $400/mo

Indie cafés, Toronto

One of each, by hand

- **Walk-ins:** after the morning rush, 25 a week
- **One online forum** where Toronto owners already talk

FIRST 100 — $4K/mo

Toronto, repeatable

Prove each channel once

- **Referrals** from the first 10
- **One BIA** or industry association
- **One trade show** booth or talk
- **Staff who move** cafés recommend it to their next manager

SCALE — $80K/mo

Canada, then the US

Multiply what worked

- **Many** BIAs and associations, city by city
- **Partnerships:** POS and payroll app marketplaces
- **Staff-alumni loop** as a system
- **Multi-location** groups

HACK **Imitation is the highest form of strategy.** Copy the channels and tactics that other vendors who sell to the same audience already use. It's the fastest way to build your own **GTM starter pack**. Then do more of what's working and less of what's not.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET

Measure each channel: one number per step



The metric for Schedify: walk-ins per paying café. Target 1 in 12. If it's 1 in 50, the channel is too expensive, and my CAC is wrong. Track real numbers and then correct your calculations.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET · THE FULL CANVAS

Now the last three boxes

Key partners

Key activities

Key resources

Value propositions

Get your Sunday nights back. Shifts get covered without you: staff swap, you tap approve.

Customer relationships

- **Get:** self-serve, plus a 15-min setup call (if needed)
- **Keep:** their whole staff uses it
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Channels

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Cost structure

CAC ~$200 a café (founder walk-ins) · hosting and SMS ~15% of revenue

Revenue streams

$40 per location, per month · 14-day free trial

Business Model Canvas by Strategyzer AG (strategyzer.com), CC BY-SA 3.0.

02 · GO-TO-MARKET · THE FULL CANVAS

The last three boxes: how you'll deliver it

Key partners

- **POS and payroll platforms:** app marketplace listings
- **BIAs and restaurant associations**
- **SMS provider** for shift alerts

Key activities

- Founder-led walk-ins
- Onboarding the whole staff
- Shipping shift-swap features

Key resources

- The app and its staff network
- Founders' café relationships
- Staff-alumni email list

Value propositions

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PART 03 · PITCH SLIDE 10

Saturday is the start line. What comes after makes or breaks your company.

Your roadmap slide shows judges what you'll prove in the next 30 days, 90 days and 6–12 months.

✓ 01 · Business model

✓ 02 · Go-to-market

03 · Roadmap

04 · Wrap up

03 · ROADMAP

Climb the traction ladder

Each checkpoint climbs a rung, and each rung costs the customer more.

NEXT 30 DAYS

1 · Validate

The problem is real, and they want your fix

- Customer conversations about a real, recent problem

NEXT 90 DAYS

2 · Build

Ship it, and get your first customers

- The smallest thing, in their hands
- Waitlist or demo sign-ups
- First paying users, pilots, or LOIs

6–12 MONTHS

3 · Grow

Revenue, customers, and the team to scale

- Revenue you can show on a chart
- One channel that repeats
- Your first key hire

03 · ROADMAP

Schedify's roadmap, filled in

NEXT 30 DAYS

Validate

30 owner conversations, pilot with 5 cafés

- Walk into 25 cafés a week
- Test the three "we assume" bets
- Waitlist live from the MVPre page

NEXT 90 DAYS

Build

Ship shift swaps and one-tap approve, reach 25 paying cafés

- Whole staff using it every week
- Convert pilots to $40 a month
- Track walk-ins per paying café

6–12 MONTHS

Grow

About 200 cafés, ~$100K a year, first hire

- Walk-ins and referrals repeating
- First BIA or association partner
- Key hire: onboarding and support lead

TIP **Be precise about the next 30 days, looser about 6–12 months.** Leave room to pivot based on what you hear in validation.

Uses the language of the BUILDYYC pitch template, slide 10. Restaurant app figures are illustrative.

03 · ROADMAP

End with one clear ask

The room is full of people who can help. Make it easy to say yes tonight.

VAGUE: NOBODY ACTS

“We’d love any feedback, support or connections!”

CLEAR: SOMEONE RAISES A HAND

“We’re looking for one café owner to be our design partner: use Schedify free for 30 days and tell us what’s broken.”

Intros to __

Feedback on __

$__ to fund __

A design partner in __

MY ASK Three intros to people in wealth management, tax accounting or family offices, for 30-minute discovery chats.

PART 04 · WRAP UP

What happened to Schedify? And what I'd do differently.

Who actually won shift scheduling, and the GTM moves I'd make if we built it again.

✓ 01 · Business model
✓ 02 · Go-to-market
✓ 03 · Roadmap
04 · Wrap up

DEBRIEF

So what happened to Schedify?

- **Too many founders.** 7 or 8 of us. Hard to get everyone in a room.
- **We never shipped.** Went for full-automation. Competitors didn't.
- **4 people stepped away.** Including me, to focus on my agency career.
- **Two angels said yes…** as long as there was a lead investor. There wasn’t.
- **Applied to YC.** Didn’t get in.
- **Disagreements about ownership and commitment.** Eventually it fizzled.

FUN FACT Gabriel has paid the renewal on schedify.com every year since. Still squatting it.

BACK TO 2010

So who won shift scheduling?

Deputy

Founded **2008** · Sydney

~375,000

workplaces; ~1.5M shift workers

Revenue not disclosed · Unicorn ($1B+) in 2024 · Bootstrapped for 9 years

When I Work

Founded **2010** · Minneapolis

200,000+

workplaces; 10M+ hourly workers have used it

~$35M revenue (est.) · $200M from Bain Capital (2021)

FUN FACT My sister runs her Toronto restaurants on When I Work.

7shifts

Founded **2014** · Saskatoon

55,000

restaurants, restaurant-only

~$52M revenue (est., 2023) · ~$122M raised · Started in a Quiznos back office

Same idea, same time period. The difference was everything after the build.

Sources: Bain Capital (2021); Unleash (Dec 2025); 7shifts / CB Insights (2026). Revenue figures are third-party estimates (Growjo, Latka).

BACK TO 2010

What I’d do differently

What we did	What I'd do now
Chased full automation, never shipped	Ship the simple fix to 5 cafés in 30 days
Figured we’d price it later	$40 a month per location, from day one
Hoped people would find it	Walk into cafés between rushes
Took “sounds great” as a yes	Get beta testers into the product and build around their fedback
Needed investors before customers	Get paying cafés first. Traction convinces lead investors.
Uneven commitment, unclear ownership	Sort out roles and ownership in the first 90 days

Same idea. Same founders. A different business.

ONE LAST THING

Go build it. Then go win.

TOMORROW

Demo your MVP. Pitch the business. Ask for something.

NEXT 90 DAYS

Ship it. Put it in front of five people. Ask them to pay/test.

AFTER THAT

Stay in touch. Your next co-founder is in this room.

BUILDYYC 2026 · WORKSHOP #3

Thank you.

Matt Hayles · GTM advisor & startup founder (stealth)

Connect with me on LinkedIn

Questions later? Send me a note.

Business Model Canvas

Free from Strategyzer

Pitch deck template

Tonight's 10-slide template